# FMAM 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 January 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

**Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast**

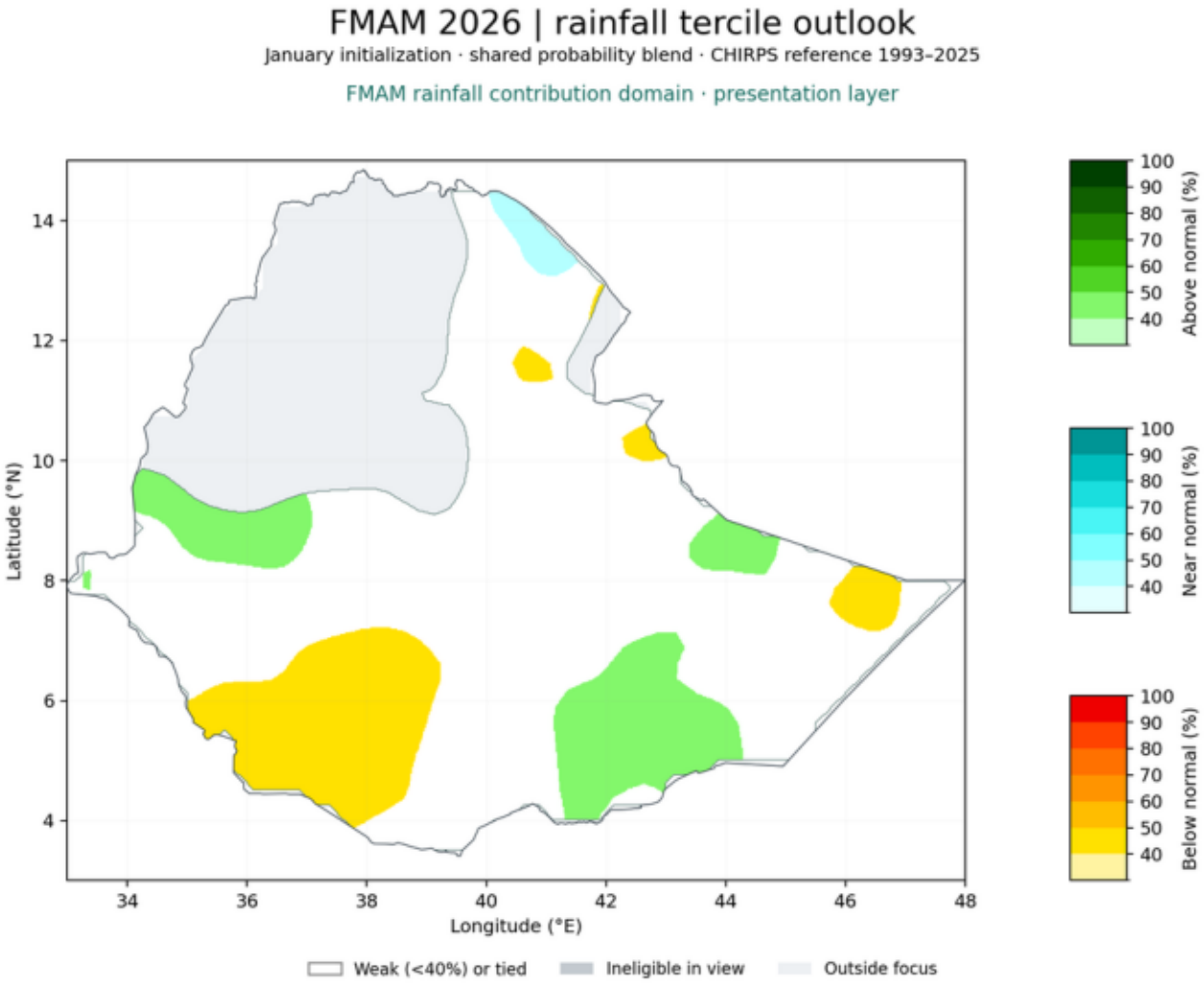
The forecast is close to climatology in the FMAM rainfall contribution domain: no tercile stands out on average. Mean forecast rainfall is 307 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 310 mm (−3 mm, −1%).

**Below normal 35%** **Near normal 31%** **Above normal 34%**

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

Forecast signal: No clear tilt (close to climatology) (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM rainfall contribution domain): Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain. Probability skill (RPSS) +0.036, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval −0.003 to +0.071; better than climatology in 18 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.




Display only: 12× interpolation; Gaussian σ=1.5 native cells (≈0.38°, softens the 1° model grid). Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
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# All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — January initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain

| Target | Below/near/above | Coverage | Anomaly | Verification status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMAM 2026 | 35% / 31% / 34% | 100% | −3 mm | Verification published |
| Feb 2026 | 30% / 36% / 35% | 91% | +1 mm | Verification published |
| Mar 2026 | 31% / 34% / 35% | 100% | +10 mm | Verification published |
| Apr 2026 | 35% / 32% / 33% | 100% | −4 mm | Verification published |
| May 2026 | 36% / 35% / 30% | 100% | −8 mm | Verification published |

### Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

| Target | RPSS (95% interval) | Yrs better | Holm p | In words |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMAM | +0.036 (−0.003 to +0.071) | 18/24 | 0.171 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Feb | +0.026 (−0.006 to +0.059) | 16/24 | 0.202 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Mar | +0.001 (−0.012 to +0.012) | 12/24 | 0.901 | Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain |
| Apr | −0.002 (−0.020 to +0.013) | 12/24 | 0.901 | No demonstrated improvement over climatology |
| May | +0.035 (+0.009 to +0.060) | 19/24 | 0.044 | Modest improvement over climatology (interval above zero) |

### Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

| Target | RPSS | CRPSS | Bias | Forecast / observed anomaly | Observed below/near/above |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMAM 2026 | −0.054 | −0.097 | −38.1 mm | −3 / +35 mm | 13% / 40% / 47% |
| Feb 2026 | −0.036 | −0.187 | +2.2 mm | +1 / −1 mm | 33% / 45% / 22% |
| Mar 2026 | +0.049 | +0.101 | −59.0 mm | +10 / +69 mm | 0% / 4% / 96% |
| Apr 2026 | +0.015 | +0.024 | +17.7 mm | −4 / −22 mm | 45% / 39% / 16% |
| May 2026 | +0.033 | +0.031 | +3.1 mm | −8 / −11 mm | 37% / 46% / 17% |

### Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 January 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 10 Oct 2026. Recalibrated with CHIRPS v3.0 when its observations for Feb 2026–May 2026 were already available (the fit itself uses 1993–2025 only): a retrospective reconstruction, not a forecast frozen before its outcome (SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v3.0 FMAM 1993–2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Feb, Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v3.0 monthly listing checked 11 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026

Verification last run: 11 Oct 2026

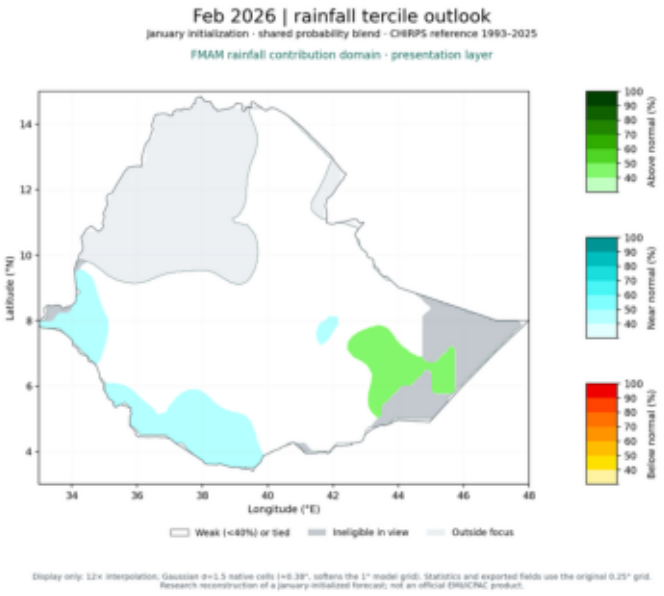
Method / version: Shared climatology blend (λ = 0.34 for FMAM) · code 007ce47

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

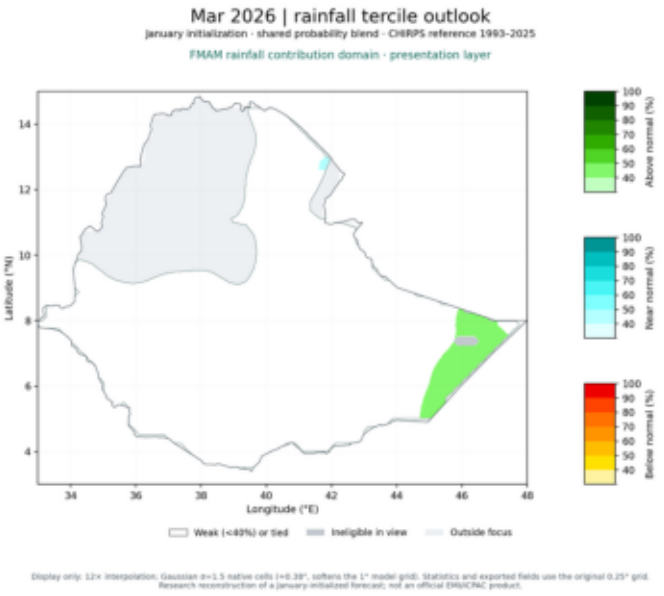
Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

# Monthly tercile outlooks

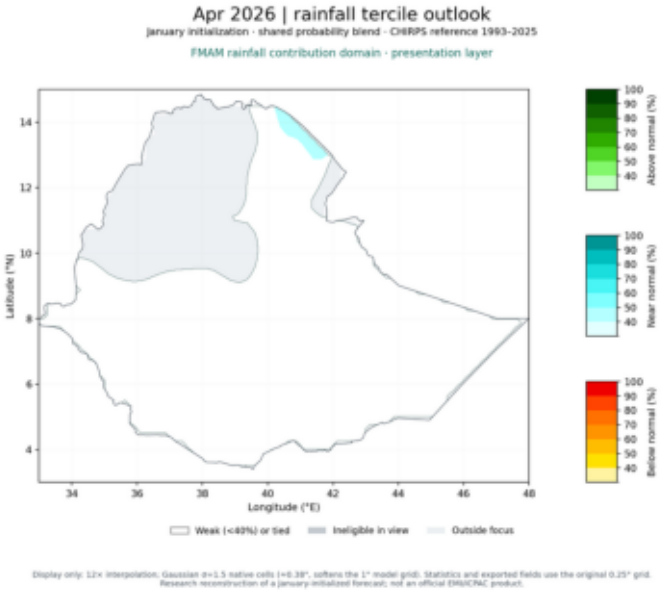
FMAM 2026 — January initialization · FMAM rainfall contribution domain



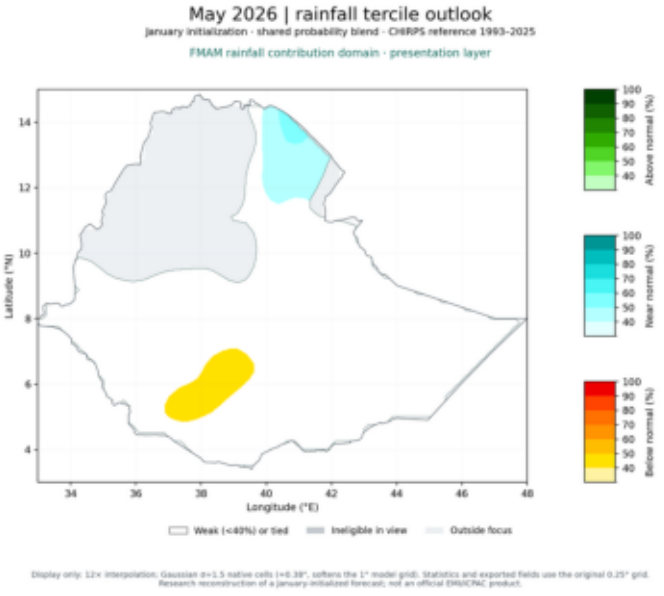

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